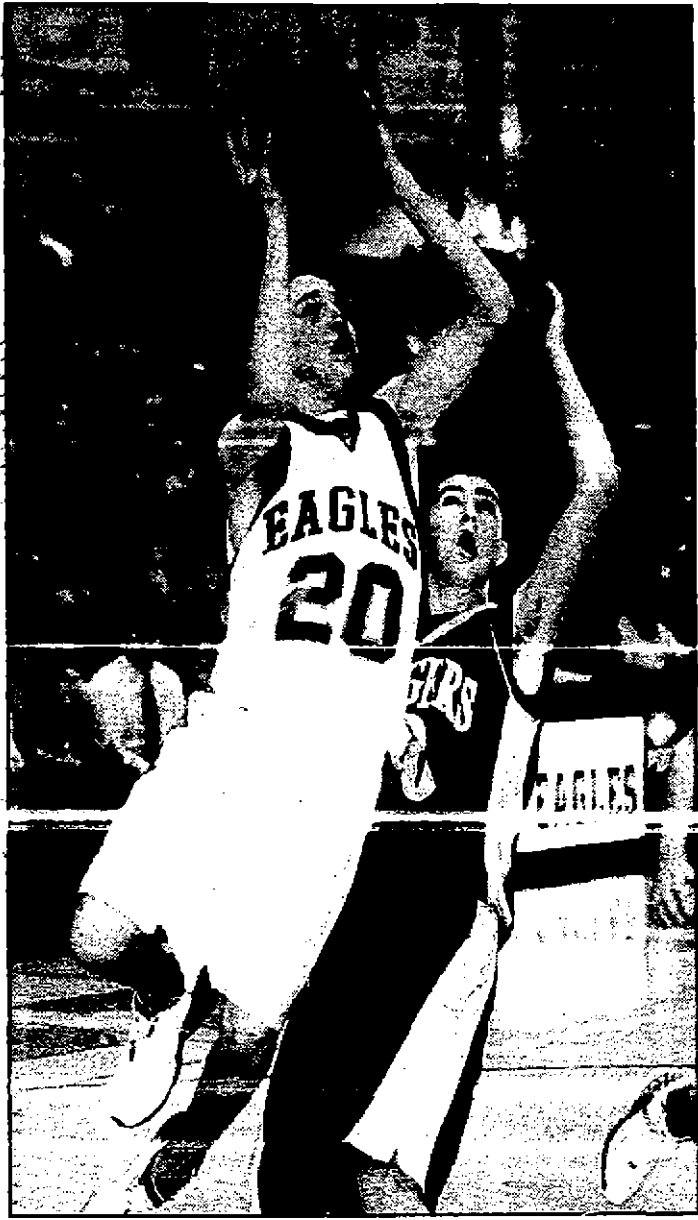


LOCAL SPORTS

Rangers finally beat Eagles



LEANING IN: North Olmsted's Dave Janis (left) takes his shot against Dan Nelson of North Ridgeville on Friday night.

Ron Nenadal
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH OLMSTED — It's been 18 years coming, but it finally happened Friday night. North Ridgeville defeated North Olmsted, 61-54, Friday night at North Olmsted High School.

The last time the Rangers beat the Eagles was November 24, 1984 when they defeated them 54-50.

"Good for them," North Olmsted coach Tim Schmotzer said when told how long it had been since North Olmsted lost to North Ridgeville. "I've been here nine years and this is the first time we've lost to them."

Rangers coach Mark Rechlin had no idea that it had been that long between wins.

"Has it really been that long?" Rechlin asked. "I was wishing we didn't have to play them the first game of the season. They are so well coached and fundamentally sound that there is no team around whose coach would want to take them on first. But I told the kids we could play and we would just have to go out and show it."

And show them they did.

The Rangers jumped out to a 13-11 first-quarter lead on the hot shooting of game-high scorer Adam Montgomery (6 points) and Josh Rigsby (7

N. RIDGEVILLE (61): Adam Montgomery 8-22, Andrew Pomackar 1-3-5, Dan Nelson 4-3-12, Ryan Schroeder 1-2-4, Andrew Tyson 1-3-5, Josh Rigsby 4-2-12. Totals 19-17-51.					
N. OLMSTED (54): Steve Trapp 7-1-16, Dave Janis 4-2-10, Mike Eccleston 2-2-6, Mike Easter 1-3-5, Chris Hahnger 3-0-7, Matt Rogalski 2-0-4, Matt Hagen 2-0-4, Brian Kissel 1-0-2. Totals 22-8-54.					
Ridgeville	13	21	11	16	— 61
N Olmsted	11	14	17	12	— 54
Three-pointers: (Ridgeville) Montgomery (3), Rigsby (2), Nelson (N Olmsted) Hahnger (1), Trapp (1).					
Fouled out: None.					
Junior varsity: North Olmsted 52-35.					

points).

They continued to build on that lead throughout the second quarter as Montgomery continued his hot shooting, hitting 3-for-3 from 3-point range. Going into the locker room, North Ridgeville led 34-25.

Coming back from intermission, the Eagles put together a run that brought them to within three points, 45-42, after three quarters. North Ridgeville turned the ball over eight times in the quarter and North Olmsted took advantage, outscoring the Rangers 17-11.

"I felt there were two things that happened in the third quarter," Rechlin said. "At one point, I felt we started rushing too much. They started over-playing our passes and waiting for us to make mistakes."

"And we helped them out a little bit. When you start to

"But I told the kids we could play and we would just have to go out and show it."

—Rangers coach Mark Rechlin

rush things, you get out of your offense. We stress an offense that makes the other team defend you. Make all five of them play defense. We want to put pressure the defense."

The Rangers settled down in the fourth quarter and made free throws down the stretch as the Eagles started fouling to get the ball back. North Ridgeville was 12 of 16 from the line in the quarter and outscored North Olmsted 16-12 to grab the win.

"I think our biggest disappointment as coaches is that our kids lost their composure in the second half," Schmotzer said. "But that was probably because North Ridgeville threw a lot of different gimmick defenses at us that our kids weren't prepared for."

"The lack of practice time probably hurt us. As the season goes along, we'll get better at handling those defenses. I'd like to play them (Ridgeville) later in the season and see what would happen."

"We told the kids that this North Ridgeville team is the best we've seen in the nine years I've been here. We knew Montgomery is their best player and we said we wanted to hold him to under 12 points. But here he has 17 at the half. We didn't do a very good job on the two things we hang our hats on, defense and keeping our composure."

Another plus for Rechlin this season is that he has people to bring the ball up court, something that has been lacking in the past.

"Don't get me wrong, I'm not criticizing the past players, but it's nice to be able to get the job done," he said. "These kids have been playing together all year. For them, this is not just a winter sport. They really have a passion for the game."

North Olmsted will travel to Strongsville tonight while North Ridgeville will wait until Tuesday to host Westlake's Demons.

O. Falls rallies past Tigers

WARRENSVILLE HTS. — Olmsted Falls' boys overcame a 34-29 halftime deficit by outscoring Warrensville Heights in the third and fourth quarters for a season-opening 77-76 non-conference win over the Tigers on Friday night.

Dan Binggeli led the Bulldogs with 23 points.

He was joined in double figures by teammates Steve Gansey and Jamaar Scales with 22 and 16 points, respectively.

OLMSTED FALLS (77): Mental 0-1-1, Binggeli 9-2-23, Braddock 2-0-4, Flomp 1-0-3, Arcin 2-0-4, Sparks 1-2-4, Gansey 10-1-22, Scales 8-0-16. Totals 33-8-77.

WARRENSVILLE HTS. (76): Spates 4-0-9.

PREP HOOPS

Johnson 6-15-29, Harrison 1-0-2, Vergie 3-0-6, James 4-1-9, Emerson 1-2-4, Wilson 3-1-7, Bachlor 4-0-8, Jacobs 1-0-2. Totals 27-19-76.					
Olmsted Falls	12	17	22	26	— 77
Warrensville Hts.	14	20	20	22	— 76
Three-pointers: (OF) Binggeli, Romp, Gansey, (WH) Spates, Johnson 2.					
Junior varsity: Warrensville Hts., 64-54.					

Fairview 67, Lutheran West 63

FAIRVIEW PARK — The Warriors grabbed a 23-13 lead after the first quarter before having to hold off Lutheran West in a well-played season-opener.

Fairview Brendan Schuler and Josh Ronschke of the

Longhorns tied for game-high scoring honors with 18 points each.

LUTHERAN WEST (63): Spurlock 2-0-4, Miller 3-1-7, Ronschke 5-6-18, Davila 3-6-12, Minnick 3-3-11, Semrau 0-1-1, Schifflin 2-2-5, Nemt 2-2-0-4. Totals 20-19-63.					
FAIRVIEW (67): Dieringer 4-0-9, Rozak 0-2-2, Schuler 4-10-18, Schaefer 2-0-5, Lukasik 3-4-10, Stanton 6-1-4, Eaden 1-1-3, Davis 2-2-6. Totals 22-19-67.					
Lutheran West	13	11	15	23	— 63
Fairview	23	10	12	22	— 67
Three-pointers: (LW) Ronschke 2, Minnick 2. (F) Dieringer, Schaefer, Stanton 2.					
Junior varsity: Lutheran West, 48-44.					

Girls

Westlake 62, Midview 55

WESTLAKE — Westlake's girls held Midview to single-digit scoring in the second and

third quarters as the Demons defeated the Middies 62-45 in non-conference action for their first win.

Kelsey Slater and Amy Banks each scored 18 points for the Demons (1-2).

Adrian Semrau (14) and Erin Wolfe (13) combined for 27 points for the Middies (2-1).

MIDVIEW (55): Krasianko 2-0-4, Bruck 2-0-4, Haney 3-0-7, Harder 1-3-5, Semrau 7-0-14, Shut 4-0-8, Wolfe 6-0-13. Totals 25-3-55.					
WESTLAKE (62): Slater 8-0-18, Fenix 1-0-2, Wise 3-0-6, Herman 1-0-2, Banks 3-0-18, Little 3-4-10, Reagan 2-0-4, Bran 1-0-2. Totals 28-4-62.					
Midview	25	7	9	13	— 55
Westlake	18	12	17	15	— 62
Three-pointers: (M) Haney, Wolfe, (W) Slater 2.					
Junior varsity: Westlake, 49-39.					

PREP HOCKEY

Panthers fall to Normanday

PARMA — Normandy's Mark Monaco scored the game-winning goal with six and a half minutes left to play as the Invaders eked out a 3-2 win over Elyria Catholic Friday in the first round of the Normandy Thanksgiving Tournament at Ries Arena.

David Bessas and Mike McLaughlin each scored a goal for the Panthers (2-1), while Evan Elish had two assists.

Elyria Catholic goalie Chris Hand made 25 saves.

The Panthers prepare to face Brooklyn today at 5 p.m. in the second round of the tournament.

GOALS: (EC) David Bessas, Mike McLaughlin; (N) Tim Lang, Justin Yuchenko, Mark Monaco.

ASSISTS: (EC) Bessas, Evan Elish 2, Jeff Kwastny; (N) Ryan Beskid, Randy Saxon, Joe Mazzeo, Monaco.

SHOTS-ON-GOAL: Elyria Catholic 24; Normandy 28.

SAVES: (EC) Chris Hand 25; (N) Joe Gezymalla 22.

SCORE BY PERIODS: Elyria Catholic 1-0-1-2; Normandy 0-2-1-3.

Southwestern Conference Tournament

Rocky River 5, Bay 2

ROCKY RIVER — Ryan Andrews and Drew Dixon each scored two goals and had two assists for the Pirates (2-1) as they handed Bay its first loss.

Drew DeWitt and Danny Wise scored the goals for the Rockets (4-1), while Bay goalie Marc Cleary made 13 saves.

GOALS: (B) Drew DeWitt, Danny Wise; (RR) Ryan Andrews 2, Drew Dixon 2, Mike Henderson.

ASSISTS: (B) Pat Wise, Jim Datko, Pat Madden, Derek Lindsay; (RR) Andrews 2, Dixon 2, Dean Hoyt 2, Blake Fredrickson.

SHOTS-ON-GOAL: Bay 29; Rocky River 18.

SAVES: (B) Marc Cleary 13; (RR) Jose Cruz 27.

SCORE BY PERIODS: Bay 0-1-1-2; Rocky River 3-2-0-5.

North Olmsted 4, Olmsted Falls 2

ROCKY RIVER — Kyle Wilson, Matt Sullivan and Erik Apelis each scored a goal and had an assist for the Eagles (3-1).

Ryan Burrows scored a goal and had an assist for the Bulldogs, while Patrick Walsh scored the other goal for Olmsted Falls.

GOALS: (NO) Kyle Wilson, Matt Sullivan, Mike Austin, Erik Apelis; (OF) Ryan Burrows, Patrick Walsh.

ASSISTS: (NO) Jake Troxell, Wilson, Apelis, Sullivan; (OF) Andy Antoniczak, Burrows.

SHOTS-ON-GOAL: North Olmsted 29; Olmsted Falls 21.

SAVES: (NO) Brad Wysoniowski 19; (OF) Craig Burrows 25.

SCORE BY PERIODS: North Olmsted 2-0-2-4; Olmsted Falls 0-0-2-2.

BULLETIN BOARD

BASEBALL/SOFTBALL

CSU BASEBALL LESSONS: Cleveland State University is offering private hitting and pitching lessons for youth 8 years of age and older. One hour of private lessons costs \$50, while a 10-week session costs \$400. A 10-week group session costs \$300 per person. For more information, phone Brian at (216) 687-9208.

WINTER BASEBALL: There will be Joe Charbonneau baseball and fastpitch softball on Dec. 30-31 from 10 a.m. to 1 p.m. at the Lorain County Community College Field House-Ewing Activities Center. The winter break action is for boys and girls ages 6-15 and costs \$90 per person. For more information, call (440) 353-0344.

SCHOOL NOTICES

SPARTANS HAVE OPENINGS: Lorain Catholic has three openings for the 2003-2004 boys basketball season. If interested, call coach Matt Lawhead at 282-8216 or 288-8151. Interested primarily in teams from Lorain County.

AVON LAKE SEEKS THROWS COACH: Avon Lake High School is seeking a throws coach for its boys and girls track and field teams. Interested persons are asked to send a letter of intent to Avon Lake High School Athletic Department, attention: Thomas R. Barone, 175 Avon Belden Road, Avon Lake 44012 or call Tom Barone at (440) 933-5164.

BLACK RIVER SEEKS BASKETBALL COACHES: Black River High School is seeking junior high basketball coaches for its boys and girls teams. Interested persons are asked to contact Paul Keenan at the high school at (419) 736-3303.

RUNNING

HERMES EVENTS: Hermes Sports will have its third Salomon Smith Barney Reindeer Run on Dec. 7. The run is a 5K event that starts at 9 a.m. at Sweetwater Landing in the Cleveland Metroparks. Call Hermes at (216) 623-9933 or visit www.hermescleveland.com.

GENERAL

ICE RINK PASSES: The Elyria Parks and Recreation Department is selling season passes for the North Park Ice Rink. Passes are on sale only at the Hilltop office at 1231 Gulf Road. Office hours are Monday through Friday from 8 a.m. to 4:30 p.m. Pass fees are youth \$34; adult \$44; 55 and older \$39; family of 3-4 \$79 and family of 5 or more \$89. Non-residents add \$5 for individual passes and \$10 for family passes. For more information, call (440) 365-7101.

SCORES

Area

BOYS BASKETBALL

Non-conference
Elyria 58, Nordonia 33
Elyria Catholic 44, Midview 37
Columbia 61, Clearview 54
Vermilion 76, Firelands 74
Keystone 56, Westlake 51 (OT)
Fairview 67, Lutheran West 63
North Ridgeville 61, North Olmsted 54
Olmsted Falls 77, Warrensville Heights 76

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Non-conference
Westlake 62, Midview 55

HOCKEY
Normandy Thanksgiving Tournament
At Ries Arena
Normandy 3, Elyria Catholic 2
Southwestern Conference Tournament
At Rocky River
Rocky River 5, Bay 2
North Olmsted 4, Olmsted Falls 2

Across the state

BOYS BASKETBALL

Ade 54, Pandora 39
Akr. Buchtel 51, Stow-Munroe Falls 50
Anna 49, Houston 41
Ansonia 65, Tri-County N. 61
Anthony Wayne 93, Tontogany Orsago 85
Antwerp 53, Fayette 51
Arcanum 78, Tri-Village 67, OT
Aurora 63, Hamilton 44, 50
Austin/Jefferson 60, Massillon 60
Barnesville 58, Shadyside 42
Bascom Hopewell-Loudon 59, Vanlue 35
Beaumont 96, Bridgeport 58
Bellefontaine 63, Sidney 29
Bellevue 46, Lexington 45
Beverly Ft. Frye 84, McCormalsville Morgan 80
Brunswick 66, Niagara (N.Y.) Wheatfield 15
Bucyrus 76, Ashland Creechview 42
Byzantine Meadowbrook 68, Sarasota 67
Shenandoah 58

Camden Preble Shawnee 67, Middletown Madison 46
Can. McKinley 68, Alliance 31
Can. S. 73, Can. Cent. Cath. 39
Canal Winchester 73, Pickerington 69, 3 OT
Cardington Lincoln 71, Crestline 45
Carrollton 60, Harrison Cent. 39
Castwood Miami E. 62, Day, Chr. 46
Cedarville 49, Spring, Shawnee 40
Cedarville 49, Spring, Shawnee 40
Celina 61, Piqua 44
Chillicothe Huntington 60, Latham W. 28
Cin. Deer Park 72, Cin. Landmark 68
Cin. Finneytown 79, Cin. NW 75
Cin. Moeller 55, Cin. Oak Hills 36
Cin. Roger Bacon 64, Cin. Winton Woods 59
Circleville 68, Chillicothe Union 48
Clarksville Clinton-Massie 70, Waynesville 64
Clayton Northmont 89, Tipp City Tippecanoe 64
Cle. St. Ignatius 76, Padua 37
Cleveland Hts. 84, Cols. Millin 79
Clyde 71, Tiffin Columbian 60
Columwood 68, Nathaniel Hawthorne 25
Coks. Bayley 89, Coks. S. 64
Coks. Wintonstone 68, Worthington Chr. 60
Continental 78, Paulding 49
Covington 61, Bradford 49
Creston Norwayville 51, Medina Buckeye 46
Dalton 42, Massillon Tusley 37
Danbury 69, Gibsonburg 47
Day, Belmont 72, Middletown 66
Defiance Aynsville 63, McComb 36
Deerfield 67, Peninsula 30
Deshler 67, Peninsula 30
Dublin Coffman 70, Cols. Centennial 41
E. Liverpool 51, Spring, Local 46
Elmwood 65, Fostonia St. Wendelin 63
Elyria Cath. 44, Grafton Midview 37
Fairborn 74, Yellow Springs 52
Fairfield Union 67, Granville 59
Fairview 50, Jackson Center 48
Franklin 50, Jackson Center 48
Franklin-Monroe 78, Newton 73
Fronton Ross 68, Bowling Green 59
Grand Indian Valley 76, Danville 48
Goshen 65, Faircity-Franklin 45
Greenview 49, Northwestern 46, OT
Greensville 52, Euton 40
Grovesport 50, Galloway Westland 37
Hamlet Patrick Henry 65, Buffalo 48
Hanoverton United 73, Beloit W. Branch 67
Hilland Davidson 45, Ashland 43
Holgate 54, Tot. Chr. 44

Huron 49, Norwalk St. Paul 46
Indian Lake 69, W. Liberty-Salem 60
Jackson 62, Frankfort Adams 52
Kalida 61, Ft. Recovery 59, OT
Kings Mills 75, Cin. Indian Hill 61
Kirtland 38, Orwell Grand Valley 32
Lancaster 72, Marion Harding 44
Lancaster Fisher Cath. 75, Marion Cath. 24
Lewis Center Orlangetta 66, Delaware Buckeye Valley 80
Liberty Benton 59, Upper Scioto Valley 42
Lima 65, Cin. Aiken 49
Lima Cent. Cath. 49, Bath 37
Lima Shawnee 68, Elida 74
Logan Elm 73, Seaman N. Adams 43
London 66, Madison Plains 55
Lore City Buckeye Trail 72, New Matamoras Frontier 65
Loudonville 73, Jeromesville Hillsdale 39
Lynchburg-Clay 73, Hillsboro 72
Mansfield Temple Chr. 59, Greenwich S. Cent. 55
Marion River Valley 69, Gallon Northmor 42
Massillon Jackson 54, Cig. Rhodes 51
Maumee 52, Swanton 28
Mecoma Evergreen 76, Pioneer Int. Cent. 51
Middlefield Cardinal 57, Chardon NDCI 53
Midpark Salem 54, Youngs, Chaney 52
Milbury Lake 52, N. Wood 51
Miller City 51, Ft. Jennings 59
Millersburg W. Holmes 78, Sugar Creek Garraway 74, 50T
Mt. Blanchard Riverside 72, Carey 65
Mt. Gilead 81, Howard E. Knox 65
Mt. Orab W. Brown 68, Fayetteville 48
N. Can. Hoover 53, Louisville 42
N. Lewisburg 72, Millard Center Fairbanks 50
Navarre Fairless 77, Can. Timken 64
New Concord John Glenn 64, Dover 54
New Knoxville 72, Waynesfield 64
New Knoxville 72, Waynesfield Goshen 64
New London 68, Milan Edison 37
New Philadelphia 71, Akr. N. 57
New Riegel 55, N. Robinson Cent. Crawford 54
Newark 53, Cols. W. 44
Newark Licking Valley 46, Dresden Tri-Village 45
Norwalk 69, Sandusky Perkins 56
Oak Harbor 87, Geneva 48
Old Fort 67, Kansas Lakota 53
Ontario 60, Bensley Clear Fork 51
Oregon Clay 51, Tot. Start 47

Ottawa-Glandorf 65, Byran 34
Ottoville 66, Cory Rawson 64
Pataskala Watkins Memorial 46, Ballimore Liberty Union 44
Pettisville 74, Delta 41
Plymouth 64, Mansfield Chr. 47
Port Clinton 66, Elmore Woodmore 49
Rayland Bucyke Local 59, Wintersville Indian Creek 45
Reynoldsburg 51, Mt. Vernon 45
Richfield Revere 75, Normandy 59
Russia 51, Bolkins 34
St. Charles SE 47, W. Jefferson 35
Sandusky 56, Tot. Libbey 55
Shelby 50, Mansfield Madison 46
Solon 80, Wickliffe 51
Sparta Highland 48, Fredericktown 38
Spring, Greenon 81, Mechanicsburg 61
Spring, N. 83, Kenton Ridge 64
Spring, S. 76, Tecumseh 47
St. Marys 65, Sioney Lenman 66
St. Pauls Graham 61, DeGraff Riverside 57
Riverside Stebbins 81, Huber Hts. Wayne 72
Strasburg-Franklin 43, Rittman 18
Strongsville 79, Brooklyn 59
Summit Station Licking Heights 63, Johnstown 47
Sunbury Big Walnut 57, Galien 55
Sylvania S. View 66, Tot. Rogers 45
Tallmadge 70, Kent Roosevelt 46

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Ashtabula Sts. John & Paul 49, Cle. MLK 37
Barton Berkshire 47, Gates Mills Hawken 21
Caledonia 27, Fremont Pike 18
Kirtland 38, Orwell Grand Valley 32
Middletown Fernick 48, Middleton 46
Mt. DeCharle (Pa.) 71, Louisville St. Aquinas 53
Perry 64, W. Geauga 51
St. Euclid Regina 62, Clinton (Pa.) 35
Sharon (Pa.) Kennedy 54, Conneaut 35
Westlake 62, Grafton Midview 55
Worthington 57, Wickliffe 23



TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE

THEY'VE GOT THE MOJO: Elyria Catholic fans enjoy the last few moments of Friday night's victory.

PANTHERS

From D1

"Tim Worley had a heckuva first half," said Midview coach Troy DiFranco. Worley had six points and six rebounds and got into the paint with baseline drives.

Jackson and Mike Clapham shut him out in the second half.

"At halftime they pointed out that he had no left hand, so I just tried to force him left," Jackson said.

Whatever it was, EC did the job on defense.

Midview, which shot 50 percent in the first quarter in racing to a 16-8 lead, shot only 26 percent the rest of the way.

The Middies had no turnovers in the first quarter, but when the Panthers turned up the defensive pressure, they threw it away 16 times in the last three.

Midview was 0-for-10 from behind the 3-point line.

And EC did it without fouling. Only nine fouls were whistled against the Panthers, including the technical, and Midview had only three chances from the stripe to EC's 27. The Panthers sank 15.

Elyria Catholic needed them all because Midview played excellent defense as well.

And the Middies' post players, David DiFranco and Feierabend, out-played EC's 6-foot-7 tandem of Jason Smith and Josh Brenning.